

# Digital Literature Review

ENG487 | MW3-4:15 | RB284

## Instructor Information

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### Faculty Advisor/Professor: Dr. Kathryn Ludwig

kludwig@bsu.edu

Office: RB335

Office Hours: TBA

Zoom Personal Room Address:

<https://bsu.zoom.us/j/7768955083>

### TA: Jack Vaught

jacklyn.vaught@bsu.edu

## Course Description

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The Apple TV series, *Severance*, is a sci-fi literalization of the idea that we exist differently in different spaces—that not just our activities but our very identities depend on the spaces we occupy. In this year's DLR, we will dig into the connection between space/spaces and our selves and societies. Course reading and viewing will allow us to consider both physical spaces (landscapes, cities, and domestic spaces) and theoretical spaces (liminal and hybrid spaces, inner space, and digital space). We will (1) explore the ways in which these spaces shape us, (2) critique social constructions of space, and (3) consider what is gained when we imagine "impossible" spaces. Students will be introduced to the "spatial turn" in literary studies and will also explore how conversations focused on space show up in other fields (such as geopolitics and ecocriticism).

Students in the course will also conduct their own research, design an issue of the *Digital Literature Review* journal, and develop a publicity campaign to both solicit journal submissions and promote the issue we create as a class. English majors will complete their capstone projects in this course (earning ENG 444 credit), and all students will gain invaluable analytical, writing, editing, publishing, marketing, and digital media skills.

## Course Materials

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Calvino, Italo. *Invisible Cities*: ISBN: 9780156453806

Robinson, Marilynne. *Housekeeping*. ISBN: 978-0312424091

Wilson, "Fences" (available online)

We will view selected episodes of the AppleTV series *Severance* together in class. We will also look at Chris Ware's *Building Stories* in class, but students are *not* expected to obtain this text for themselves. Other course materials (including poetry, short stories, and critical theory) will be made available on Canvas.

## Course Assignments and Assessments

### GRADING CONTRACT

In this course, we will employ [contract grading](#), which means that your grade for the course will be based on the *quantity* of satisfactory work that you complete. The *quality* of work will be assured by meeting assignment specifications and by engaging instructor and peer feedback. Instead of assigning letter grades to your assignments, I will share my expectations for the assignment. If you meet these expectations, you will earn a “complete.” If you do not meet these expectations, you will earn an “incomplete,” and you are encouraged to revise the assignment until it is marked “complete.” Minor assignments may be revised and resubmitted until the end of the unit. **For Major Assignments, you MUST REVISE until you achieve “complete.”**

### What will be required to receive an ‘A/A-’?

A grade of “complete” on MAJOR ASSIGNMENTS

A grade of “complete” on 90% or more of PARTICIPATION assignments: A (93–100), A- (90–92)

Late policy: You may turn in up to 3 late assignments with no advance notice or penalty.

(Note: I will not consider an assignment late if you email me before the deadline to request an extension and propose a new deadline).

### What will be required to receive a ‘B+/B/B-’?

A grade of “complete” on MAJOR ASSIGNMENTS

A grade of “complete” on 80% or more of PARTICIPATION assignments: B+ (87–89), B (83–86), B- (80–82)

Late policy: You may turn in up to 4 late assignments with no advance notice or penalty.

### What will be required to receive a ‘C+/C/C-’?

A grade of “complete” on MAJOR ASSIGNMENTS

A grade of “complete” on 70% or more of PARTICIPATION assignments: C+ (77–79), C (73–76), C- (70–72)

Late policy: You may turn in up to 5 late assignments with no advance notice or penalty.

## MAJOR ASSIGNMENTS:

- 2 Blog Posts
- Research Essay

**Blog Posts:** One of the goals of the *DLR* is to connect academic research to a broader audience. As part of that effort toward connection, we’ll be keeping a blog reporting on the *DLR*’s development, interesting research we come across, and discussions of multispecies representations in literary and popular culture. Each member of the class will be responsible for writing, revising, and publishing at least 2 posts during the semester. The Design team

will be responsible for editing these posts, and the publicity team will work to develop a schedule for these posts.

**Final Essay:** This capstone assignment is meant to give you an opportunity to demonstrate your mastery of a variety of academic skills—analytical reading and writing, research, revision, and preparation your manuscript for publication. How you balance those skills and the form your project takes are (mostly) up to you, within some specific assignment guidelines. Your ultimate goal will be to produce a research-driven project of some kind that engages with spatiality. This project will be eligible for publication in the DLR.

## PARTICIPATION ASSIGNMENTS:

- Active engagement in class discussions and one-on-one conferences
- 1 Theory presentation (group assignment)
- Completion of essay scaffolding assignments (Abstract, Annotated Bibliography, and Draft), in-class activities, and reading responses
- Projects in your Journal Teams

**Class Participation:** You are expected to be a thoughtful and committed presence in our class throughout the semester. Being fully present means that you should:

- come to class having read the material and completed any assigned work
- ask and answer questions
- communicate with your team
- engage with your peers and me in accordance with our common agreement.

It also means cell phones and any material not directly related to the activity, including headphones, social media, etc. need to be put away. On *DLR* work days, I expect you to devote your attention to projects related to the *DLR*.

**1 Theory Presentation:** You will work in small groups to read, analyze, and teach a scholarly article to your classmates. You will sign up for one scholarly article relevant to our course themes. Your presentation should introduce the article's central claims, methodologies, and relevance and draw connections to other course materials.

**Essay Scaffolding Assignments:** To support the development of your final essay, you will submit (1) an Abstract, in which you state your research question, provide context, and outline your argument; (2) an Annotated Bibliography, which compiles and provides citations and summaries for sources; and (3) an Essay Draft for feedback.

**Journal Teams:** You will be part of a team working on some aspect of the journal—editorial, publicity, or design. Each team will research best practices in its field and communicate those ideas to the class. While many elements of the journal will be developed by the class as a whole, it will be up to individual working teams to enact those decisions. On check-in days, you and your partners will provide short reports on your progress and outline your plans for the coming weeks. Because different aspects of this journal will have different deadlines and pressures, you will be expected to liaise with and even move among teams as necessary. Your grade will reflect your active participation, self-assessment, and peer evaluations.

## Class Norms

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### MEET DEADLINES

Real-world writing comes with real-world deadlines. You will be responsible for getting all work in on time, including those assignments that are part of our learning and preparation for project work. In extenuating circumstances, communicate with me before the deadline to work out an alternate timeline. The Grading Contract below lists the number of permitted late submissions by grade. Should you miss class, it is your responsibility to find out what you missed and meet deadlines.

### DO ORIGINAL WORK

Students are expected to submit only their own original work and they are expected to give credit when borrowing, quoting, or paraphrasing, using appropriate citation. Failure to do so is a violation of the Code of Student Rights and Responsibilities as defined by the student academic ethics policy and will be treated as such. Also know that using generative AI (Artificial Intelligence) tools to complete your assignments is a violation of Ball State's [Student Academic Ethics Policy](#), unless the AI use is explicitly approved by the faculty member. Because of the many ways in which AI can be counterproductive to your progress toward course learning goals, **we have a no-AI policy in this class.**

## Student Support Services

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**The Basic Needs Hub** If you are having difficulty affording enough food, do not have a safe and reliable place to sleep, and/or experiencing an emergency or crisis, help is available through the [Basic Needs Hub](#). The Basic Needs Hub has information, resources, and provides individualized support to students. To talk with a supportive staff member about your experience, receive one on one assistance, or learn more about resources, you can submit a [Basic Needs Assistance Form](#).

### The Counseling Center

The Ball State University Counseling Center offers free and confidential services to all students. The Counseling Center is located in Lucina Hall, Room 320. To schedule an appointment, you can contact us at 765-285-1736. Ball State also offers a 24/7 Crisis Line, which can be reached at 765-285-HOPE (4673). The Crisis Line is a mental health resource for those who are struggling with any mental health concerns, including thoughts of self-harm and/or suicide. All Ball State students also have access to several on-demand, self-help resources through a variety of different platforms. All of these resources, including a direct link to our website, can be found [here](#).

# University Policies

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## Diversity Statement

Ball State University aspires to be a university that attracts and retains a diverse faculty, staff, and student body. We are committed to ensuring that all members of the community are welcome, through valuing the various experiences and worldviews represented at Ball State and among those we serve. We promote a culture of respect and civil discourse as expressed in our [Beneficence Pledge](#) and through university resources found [here](#).

## Disability Statement

If you need course adaptations or accommodations because of a disability, please contact me as soon as possible. Ball State's [Disability Services](#) office coordinates services for students with disabilities; documentation of a disability needs to be on file in that office before any accommodations can be provided. Disability Services can be contacted at 765-285-5293 or [dsd@bsu.edu](mailto:dsd@bsu.edu).

## FERPA and Privacy

As a student, your educational records are considered confidential. Under FERPA (Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act), your records are confidential and protected. Under most circumstances, your records will not be released without your written and signed consent. However, some directory information may be released to third parties without your prior consent unless a written request to restrict this is on file. You can learn more about student rights to privacy by reading [Ball State's FERPA and Privacy and Protection](#).

## COURSE SCHEDULE Fall 2025

This schedule is subject to change. It is your responsibility to communicate with classmates to learn about missed content and schedule changes.

| Date               | In class                                                                                                               | Readings & Assignments                                                                                                |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>W1: M 8/18</b>  | Day One course intro: read DLR handbook (first 10 pages) and discuss teams; DLR Roundtable                             |                                                                                                                       |
| <b>W1: W 8/20</b>  | <b>Severance</b> day 1 viewing and discussion                                                                          | Browse DLR back issues ( <a href="http://www.bsu.edu/dlr">http://www.bsu.edu/dlr</a> ); Submit preference form Sunday |
|                    |                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                       |
| <b>W2: M 8/25</b>  | <b>Severance</b> day 2                                                                                                 | Read Soja, "Thirdspace: Expanding the Scope of the Geographical Imagination" and submit response <i>before class</i>  |
| <b>W2: Th 8/27</b> | Editorial, publicity, and design teams announced in class. Team meetings; Publicity work with Jack to plan Star Party  | Submit team work plans Sunday                                                                                         |
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| <b>W3: M 9/1</b>   | Labor Day – no class                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                       |
| <b>W3: W 9/3</b>   | <b>Severance</b> day 3; Theory Presentation intro & sign-up. Sign up for 15-minute team meetings w Dr. Ludwig and Jack | Richardson, "Mapping the Literary Text" and submit response <i>before class</i>                                       |
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| <b>W4: M 9/8</b>   | TP1 Bachelard, "The House, From Cellar to Garret: The Significance of the Hut"; <b>Invisible Cities</b>                | Read Calvino, <i>Invisible Cities</i>                                                                                 |
| <b>W4: W 9/10</b>  | TP2 Edward Said <i>Orientalism</i> , "Imaginative Geography and Its Representations"; <b>Invisible Cities</b>          | Read Calvino, <i>Invisible Cities</i>                                                                                 |
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|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>W5: W 9/15</b>   | TP3 Michel de Certeau, "Spatial Stories"; create class glossary                                                    | Read Bishop, " <a href="#">The Moose</a> ," " <a href="#">Questions of Travel</a> ," " <a href="#">The Map</a> ," " <a href="#">One Art</a> ," " <a href="#">In the Waiting Room</a> " |
| <b>W5: F 9/17</b>   | DLR Blog strategy session                                                                                          | Skim the <a href="#">DLR blog</a> and come up with 2-3 ideas                                                                                                                           |
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| <b>W6: W 9/22</b>   | TP4 Tuan, "Architectural Space and Experience," <i>Place and Space</i><br>In class: <b><i>Building Stories</i></b> |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>W6: F 9/24</b>   | In class: <b><i>Building Stories</i></b>                                                                           | Blog post draft 1 due Sunday                                                                                                                                                           |
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| <b>W7: M 9/29</b>   | Katie Bonhert visit, blog post revisions                                                                           | Revised blog post due Tuesday                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>W7: W 10/1</b>   | Tally class discussion, theory check-in and glossary update; Team check-ins                                        | Read Tally, "The Space of the Novel"                                                                                                                                                   |
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| <b>W8: M 10/6</b>   | Fall Break (no class)                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>W8: W 10/8</b>   | <b><i>Housekeeping</i></b>                                                                                         | Read Robinson, <i>Housekeeping</i> , ch. 1-6                                                                                                                                           |
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| <b>W9: M 10/13</b>  | TP5 Massey, "Space, Place, and Gender";<br><b><i>Housekeeping</i></b>                                              | Read Robinson, <i>Housekeeping</i> , ch. 7-9                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>W9: W 10/15</b>  | Team work day                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| <b>W10: M 10/20</b> | <b><i>Housekeeping</i></b>                                                                                         | Read Robinson, <i>Housekeeping</i> , ch. 10-11                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>W10: W 10/22</b> | TP6 bell hooks, "Choosing the Margin as a Space of Radical Openness";<br><b>"Fences"</b>                           | Read Wilson, "Fences," Act one                                                                                                                                                         |
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| <b>W11: M 10/27</b> | TP7 Homi K. Bhabha, intro to <i>The Location of Culture</i><br><b>"Fences"</b>                                     | Read Wilson, "Fences," Act two                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>W11: W 10/29</b> | Intro to Journal article/capstone paper                                                                            | Read Belcher, "Writing an Effective Critical Abstract"                                                                                                                                 |
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| <b>W12: M 11/3</b>                                                            | In class work on Research Abstracts                                                             |                                                                                |
| <b>W12: W 11/5</b>                                                            | Intro to annotated bib, help finding sources                                                    | Read “How to Write and Annotated Bibliography”<br>Research Abstract due Sunday |
|                                                                               |                                                                                                 |                                                                                |
| <b>W13: M 11/10</b>                                                           | Space in indigenous storytelling and poetry;<br>Team work/abstract feedback                     | Read selections from Harjo, <i>American Sunrise</i>                            |
| <b>W13: W 11/12</b>                                                           | Outer space;<br>Team work/abstract feedback                                                     | Readings TBA                                                                   |
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| <b>W14: T 11/18</b>                                                           | Open Journals dry run with Jack/InDesign dry run/Publicity plan for Feb crowdfunding            | Sign up for one-on-one paper conferences                                       |
| <b>W14: Th 11/20</b>                                                          | Open Journals dry run with Jack/InDesign dry run/Publicity plan for Feb crowdfunding            | Annotate Bib due Sunday                                                        |
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| <b>W15: M 11/24</b>                                                           | One-on-one paper <a href="#">conferences</a>                                                    |                                                                                |
| <b>W15: W 11/26</b>                                                           | THANKSGIVING BREAK (no class)                                                                   |                                                                                |
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| <b>W16: M 12/1</b>                                                            | One-on-one paper <a href="#">conferences</a>                                                    |                                                                                |
| <b>W16: W 12/3</b>                                                            | Research essay work day                                                                         |                                                                                |
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| <b>W17: M 12/8</b>                                                            | Publicity work for Feb crowdfunding/Draft 1 feedback meeting w Dr. Ludwig/Abstracts due for PCM |                                                                                |
| <b>Final Project: submit FULL research essay by end of final exam period.</b> |                                                                                                 |                                                                                |